



INTERNAL PLAYBOOK · RECRUITMENT PORTAL

How **Recruitment** Actually Works

Everything the team needs to run the junior recruitment cycle end to end — registration, orientation, exams, shortlisting, interview day, and training. Written for volunteers and leads, not for developers.

CYCLE

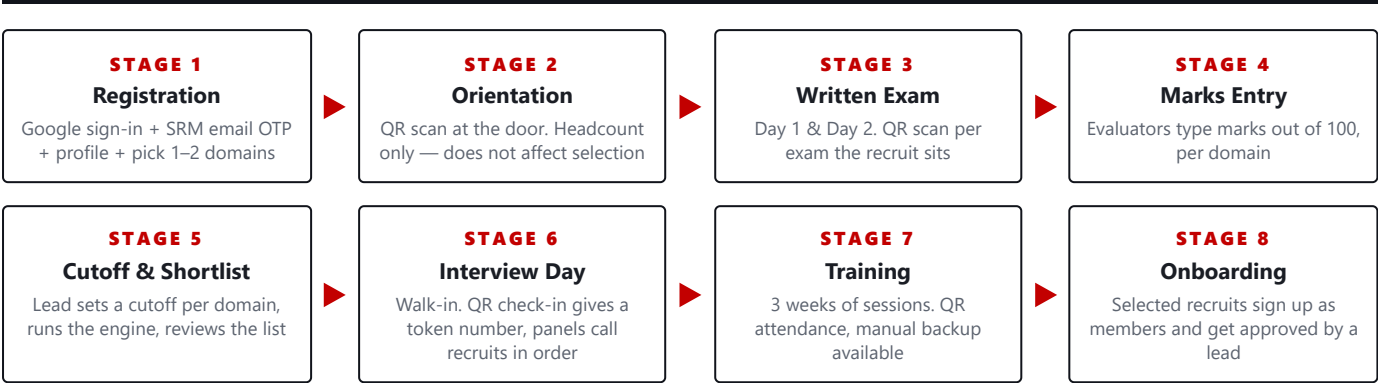
PORTAL

ISSUED

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srmteamrobocon.in/recruit.....

01 The pipeline, start to finish

Eight stages. A recruit moves through all of them; the same QR code carries them the whole way.



THE ONE THING TO REMEMBER

A recruit gets **one QR code at registration** and it works for everything — orientation, both exam days, interview check-in, and every training session. They never get a second code. What changes is the **mode the volunteer picks on the scanner** before they start scanning.

02 The six sub-domains

A recruit picks a minimum of 1 and a maximum of 2 at registration. Every domain runs the same exam-and-cutoff pipeline.

SUB-DOMAIN	PARENT SUBSYSTEM	HOW THEY ARE SHORTLISTED
Coding	SPACED	Written exam → marks → cutoff
Web Dev	SPACED	Written exam → marks → cutoff
SIESED	SIESED	Written exam → marks → cutoff
Corporate	MCSOCD	Written exam → marks → cutoff
VFX / GFX	MCSOCD	Written exam → marks → cutoff
SAMBED	SAMBED	Written exam → marks → cutoff

TWO-DOMAIN RECRUITS — READ THIS CAREFULLY

Someone who applies for Coding *and* VFX is judged **separately in each**. They sit two exams, get two sets of marks, are compared against two different cutoffs, and can clear one and fail the other. On their dashboard they see two independent status rows. Never assume "shortlisted" means shortlisted for both.

Every recruit also submits a **LinkedIn URL** at registration. It is collected from everyone, not just the design domains, and shows up on their profile card during interviews.

03 Who can do what

Access follows your existing dashboard login. There is no separate recruitment account.

ACTION	WHO	WHERE
Scan QR codes (any mode)	MEMBER LEAD ADMIN	/recruit-scanner
Undo a scan you just made	LEAD ADMIN	/recruit-scanner
View the recruit roster, export CSV	LEAD ADMIN	/dashboard/recruitment/recruits
Enter exam marks	LEAD ADMIN	.../marks
Set cutoffs, run the shortlist engine	LEAD ADMIN	.../cutoffs
Override a shortlist decision	LEAD ADMIN	.../shortlist
Open interview panels, call recruits, log results	LEAD ADMIN	.../interview
Create training sessions, mark manual attendance	LEAD ADMIN	.../training
Create / activate / close a recruitment cycle	LEAD ADMIN	.../cycles
See own status and QR code	RECRUIT	/recruit/dashboard

Volunteers only need the scanner. If you can log into the dashboard at all, you can scan.

04 Stage 1 — Registration

Fully self-service at `/recruit/register`. Nobody on the team has to do anything here.

What the student goes through

- 1 **Sign in with Google.** Personal Gmail. This is how we get their name and a login they cannot forget. This step cannot be skipped.
- 2 **Enter their SRM email and verify an OTP.** Only `@srmist.edu.in` addresses are accepted. A 6-digit code is emailed to them and expires in 15 minutes.
- 3 **Fill in the profile form.** Name, registration number, year, department, course, phone, LinkedIn URL, a password, and their 1–2 domain choices.
- 4 **Done.** They land on `/recruit/dashboard` with their QR badge already generated.

Questions students will ask you

" ... "	ANSWER
"I didn't get the OTP."	Check spam, then resend. Max 3 OTP sends per email per hour , and 5 wrong attempts locks that code — they request a fresh one.
"Can I change my domains later?"	Not from the portal. A lead has to edit it from the recruits page.
"Can I register with just my SRM email, no Google?"	No. Google sign-in is step one and is enforced server-side.
"I forgot my password."	Log in with Google instead — same account, both paths work.
"Registration page says it's not open."	No cycle is active. A lead needs to activate one under <code>.../cycles</code> .

ONLY ONE CYCLE IS LIVE AT A TIME

Everything — registrations, scans, marks, panels — is scoped to the **active cycle**. If the wrong cycle is active, registrations silently go to the wrong place and QR codes from the other cycle are rejected at the scanner with "QR is from a different cycle". Check `.../cycles` before the first event day.

05 The scanner — the one tool every volunteer uses

`/recruit-scanner` on your phone. Works for all five scan modes.

How to use it

- 1 **Log into the dashboard on your phone**, then open `/recruit-scanner`.
- 2 **Pick the mode** — Orientation, Exam Day 1, Exam Day 2, Interview Check-In, or Training.
- 3 **Pick the second thing if the mode asks for it** — which exam domain, which panel, or which training session. The Start button stays greyed out until you do.
- 4 **Hit Start Scanning** and point the camera at the recruit's phone screen.
- 5 **Read the result card**. Green "Scan OK" = recorded. Amber "Already Scanned" = they were already counted, move on. Red "Scan Failed" = read the message.

MODE	ALSO ASKS YOU FOR	RECORDS
Orientation	Nothing	One attendance row per recruit. Headcount only.
Exam — Day 1	Which exam domain	Exam attendance for <i>that domain</i> .
Exam — Day 2	Which exam domain	Same, tagged as Day 2.
Interview Check-In	Which panel	Adds them to that panel's queue and prints a token number on screen.
Training	Which session	Attendance for that session. Only works for selected recruits.

EXAM ATTENDANCE IS PER DOMAIN, NOT PER DAY

A recruit who applied for two domains sits two exams and gets **scanned once for each** — even if both exams are on the same day. Conversely, once someone is scanned for Coding, scanning them for Coding again on Day 2 shows "Already Scanned". That is correct behaviour, not a bug.

Undo

The scanner keeps a **Recent scans** list of the last 10 scans made on that device and offers an Undo button on each. Undo needs a **lead or admin** login — if a member taps it they get "Undo needs a lead or admin". The list clears when the page reloads, so fix mistakes immediately. Interview check-ins have no Undo here; removing someone from a live queue is done from the interview dashboard.

SCANNER TROUBLESHOOTING

SYMPTOM	WHAT TO DO
"No active panels found" / "No training sessions found"	The lead hasn't created it yet, or created it after you opened the page. Tap the refresh icon next to the dropdown.
"QR is from a different cycle"	They registered in a previous cycle, or the wrong cycle is active. Escalate to a lead.
"Invalid QR"	Screenshot, cropped image, or a photo of someone else's screen that got mangled. Have them open <code>/recruit/dashboard</code> live.

SYMPTOM	WHAT TO DO
"Not shortlisted" at interview check-in	Genuinely not through. Send them to a lead, don't override at the desk.
"Not a selected recruit" at training	They weren't selected in the interview, or their result hasn't been logged yet.
Camera won't open	Browser needs camera permission and an HTTPS page. Use Chrome, not an in-app browser.
Phone dead / no phone	Note the name and reg no on paper. For training a lead can mark them present manually; for orientation and exams a lead fixes it from the dashboard afterwards.

06 Stage 2 & 3 — Orientation and exam days

The two highest-traffic days. Mostly volunteer work.

Orientation day

Station two or three volunteers at the entrance with the scanner in **Orientation** mode. That's the whole job.

Orientation attendance is **informational only** — it does not gate the exam and does not affect shortlisting. It exists so leads know real turnout versus registrations, and so the recruit's dashboard advances to **SYSTEM CHECK: PASS**.

- ☐ Confirm the right cycle is active
- ☐ Volunteers logged in and on the scanner page
- ☐ Mode set to Orientation before the doors open
- ☐ Announce: "keep your QR open on your phone"

Exam days

Set up **one scanning point per domain exam**, not one per door. The volunteer selects Exam Day 1 or Day 2, then selects the domain that room is sitting, and does not change it for the rest of the session.

A two-domain recruit walking into two different exam rooms gets scanned in both. That is the intended flow.

- ☐ One volunteer per exam room, domain pre-selected
- ☐ Double-check the domain on the mode bar at the top of the scanner
- ☐ Collect answer sheets sorted by domain — it makes marks entry far faster
- ☐ A lead on standby for undos

ATTENDANCE AND MARKS ARE INDEPENDENT

If the scanner failed in a room, **don't panic**. Evaluators can still enter marks for anyone, scanned or not. Attendance is shown next to each name in the marks table purely as a sanity check for the evaluator — it never blocks marks and never blocks shortlisting.

07 Stage 4 — Marks entry

`/dashboard/recruitment/marks` · lead or admin

- 1 Pick your **sub-domain** from the dropdown. The table loads every recruit who applied for it.
- 2 Each row shows Name, Reg No, Year, Dept, Day 1 and Day 2 attendance ticks, and a marks box.
- 3 Type a whole number from **0 to 100** and hit **Save** on that row. Anything else is rejected with "Enter an integer between 0 and 100".
- 4 Saving again overwrites the previous value — safe to correct a typo at any point.

Every save records **who entered it**. Split the sheets across evaluators by domain; two people entering marks for the same domain at the same time will just overwrite each other's rows.

Leaving marks blank is meaningful. A recruit with no marks row is marked **Pending** by the shortlist engine — not rejected. Pending recruits cannot check in for interviews, so make sure nobody is accidentally left blank before you announce results.

08 Stage 5 — Cutoffs and shortlisting

`.../cutoffs` to decide, `.../shortlist` to review · lead or admin

- 1 **Set a cutoff for each domain** on the cutoffs page and hit **Save Cutoffs**. Each domain gets its own number — they do not have to match.
- 2 **Hit Run Shortlist**. The engine compares every recruit's marks against their domain's cutoff and writes a status: `Shortlisted` (marks $\geq$ cutoff), `Not Shortlisted` (below), or `Pending` (no marks yet).
- 3 **Review on the shortlist page**. Filter by domain or status. You see marks and the method next to every decision.
- 4 **Override individually** where a lead disagrees. An override is marked `manual_override` and records who did it.

OVERRIDES SURVIVE RE-RUNS — EVERYTHING ELSE DOESN'T

You can change a cutoff and hit Run Shortlist as many times as you like; it recomputes cleanly every time. The one thing it will **never** touch is a row you manually overrode. That's deliberate — but it also means a bad override stays wrong forever until someone fixes it by hand.

If a domain has no cutoff set, the engine skips that domain entirely and nobody in it gets a status. Set all six before running.

09 Stage 6 — Interview day

`.../interview` · the most moving parts of the whole cycle

Interviews are **walk-in**. No slots, no bookings, no pre-configuration. Panels are created on the day by typing a name into a box.

Setting up, in order

- 1 **A lead opens the interview page and creates the panels.** Type a name — "Coding", "SIESED", "Corporate Panel 2" — and it goes live instantly. Multiple panels run at once, each with its own independent queue and its own token numbering starting at 1.
- 2 **Check-in volunteers switch the scanner to Interview Check-In** and select their panel. If the panel isn't in the dropdown yet, tap refresh.
- 3 **Recruits arrive and get scanned.** The scanner shows them `Token #7 - Coding`. Tell them their number out loud; they can also see it live on their own dashboard.
- 4 **The interviewer clicks Call Next.** The oldest waiting token is called and the recruit's full profile appears — name, reg no, year, dept, domains they applied for, exam marks, LinkedIn, and which domains they cleared.
- 5 **The interviewer logs the result** — Selected, Rejected, or Waitlisted, plus a note, and picks which domain the result is for. Logging the result automatically closes that token; there is no separate "done" button.
- 6 **Repeat.** Call Next again for the next recruit.

Things that will come up

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
Recruit cleared two domains	They need two check-ins — the volunteer scans them once per panel, selecting a different panel each time. They physically attend one interview at a time.
Called recruit doesn't show up	Hit No Show on that token. The panel is blocked from calling anyone else until the current called token is resolved.
Wrong result logged	Use the Correct / Fix button in the Interview Results list. Don't re-scan them.
Recruit walked off, came back later	Their token stays in the queue. Re-scanning them into the same panel just returns the existing number.
Queue looks stuck	Almost always an unresolved <code>called</code> token. Mark it done or no-show.
Panel finished	Close Panel. Waiting tokens stay visible but nobody new can be scanned in.

THERE IS A PUBLIC QUEUE SCREEN

`.../interview/panel/<panel>` is a big "NOW SERVING / NEXT UP" display built to be cast to a TV or projector in the waiting area. It needs no login and shows only token numbers and first names. Set it up if you have a screen — it kills most of the crowd noise.

TWO LIVE-DAY CAUTIONS

One: if several volunteers scan into the *same* panel simultaneously, the token-numbering has a retry guard but has not been load-tested with real concurrent traffic — one check-in device per panel is the safe setup. **Two:** panels do not auto-balance. The volunteer chooses the panel, so watch queue lengths yourself and redirect the line if one panel falls behind.

10 Stage 7 — Three weeks of training

`.../training` · lead creates sessions, volunteers scan

- 1 **A lead creates each session ahead of time** with a date and a label — "Week 1 — Day 1", and so on. Both fields are required.
- 2 **Volunteers scan in Training mode**, selecting that session from the dropdown. Only recruits marked **selected** can be scanned; anyone else gets "Not a selected recruit".
- 3 **For anyone without a phone**, a lead uses **Mark Present** on the training page. It records who marked it and flags the row as manual.
- 4 **Track it on the analytics page**, which shows attendance percentage per recruit across all sessions.

Double-marking is impossible — one attendance row per recruit per session, whether it came from a QR scan or a manual mark.

11 Stage 8 — Becoming an actual team member

The recruitment portal ends here and the normal member system takes over.

Once training is done, selected recruits go through the **existing member signup**, not the recruit portal:

- 1 They register at `/signup` with their SRM email.
- 2 They verify that email.
- 3 A lead approves them from **Review & Approvals** in the dashboard, which creates their row on the public team roster.
- 4 They can now log into the member dashboard, submit blogs, fill their timetable, and appear on the public Team page once a lead activates them.

Their recruit account and their member account are two separate things. Closing the recruitment cycle does not affect their membership.

12 What the recruit sees on their dashboard

`/recruit/dashboard` · know these labels so you can answer questions at the desk

Their dashboard is themed as a robot boot sequence. Each domain they applied for gets its **own status row**, so a two-domain recruit can be on two different labels at once.

STATUS THEY SEE	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS
POWER ON	Registered. Nothing scanned yet.
SYSTEM CHECK: PASS	Orientation attendance recorded.
DIAGNOSTIC RUNNING	Exam attendance recorded for this domain. Awaiting results.
DIAGNOSTIC: PASS	Shortlisted in this domain. Cleared the cutoff.
DIAGNOSTIC: FAIL	Not shortlisted in this domain.
CALIBRATION	Checked in for the interview, result not logged yet.
DEPLOYED	Selected in this domain. They're in.
RUNTIME ...	In training — shows their session attendance count.

They also see their **QR badge** (a lanyard-style card with their name and code), their profile details, and — on interview day only — a **live queue card** showing their token number and how many people are ahead of them. It refreshes every 10 seconds while they're in a queue and stops once they've been seen.

NOTHING LEAKS BETWEEN DOMAINS

A recruit rejected in one domain and selected in another sees exactly that, side by side. The system deliberately never shows a "you're in" signal against a domain they were rejected from.

13 Day-of checklists

Print this page. Tick it before the doors open.

BEFORE EVERY EVENT DAY

- ☐ Correct cycle is active on `.../cycles`
- ☐ Every volunteer can log into the dashboard on their own phone
- ☐ Every volunteer has opened `/recruit-scanner` and granted camera access
- ☐ At least one lead present forundos and overrides
- ☐ Phones charged / power banks on the desk
- ☐ Paper fallback sheet for names and reg numbers

EXAM DAY EXTRAS

- ☐ One scanning point per domain exam
- ☐ Correct domain selected and verified on the mode bar
- ☐ Answer sheets bundled by domain

INTERVIEW DAY EXTRAS

- ☐ All panels created before check-in starts
- ☐ One check-in device per panel
- ☐ Queue display cast to a screen in the waiting area
- ☐ Interviewers briefed: log the result to close the token
- ☐ Someone watching queue lengths across panels
- ☐ All panels closed at the end of the day

TRAINING DAY EXTRAS

- ☐ Session created with date and label before people arrive
- ☐ Lead available for manual Mark Present

14 Quick reference

RECRUITS USE

/recruit/register	Sign up
/recruit/login	Log in
/recruit/dashboard	Status + QR

VOLUNTEERS USE

/recruit-scanner	All scanning
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LEADS USE — ALL UNDER

/DASHBOARD/RECRUITMENT	
/cycles	Create, activate, close a season
/recruits	Full roster, filters, CSV export
/marks	Enter exam marks
/cutoffs	Set cutoffs, run the engine
/shortlist	Review and override
/interview	Panels, queues, results
/training	Sessions and attendance
/analytics	Funnel and breakdowns

Who to escalate to

PROBLEM	ESCALATE TO
Wrong scan, needs undoing	Any lead on site
Recruit's details are wrong	Recruitment lead
Portal is down / scanner broken for everyone	Tech lead
Disputed shortlist or interview result	Domain lead